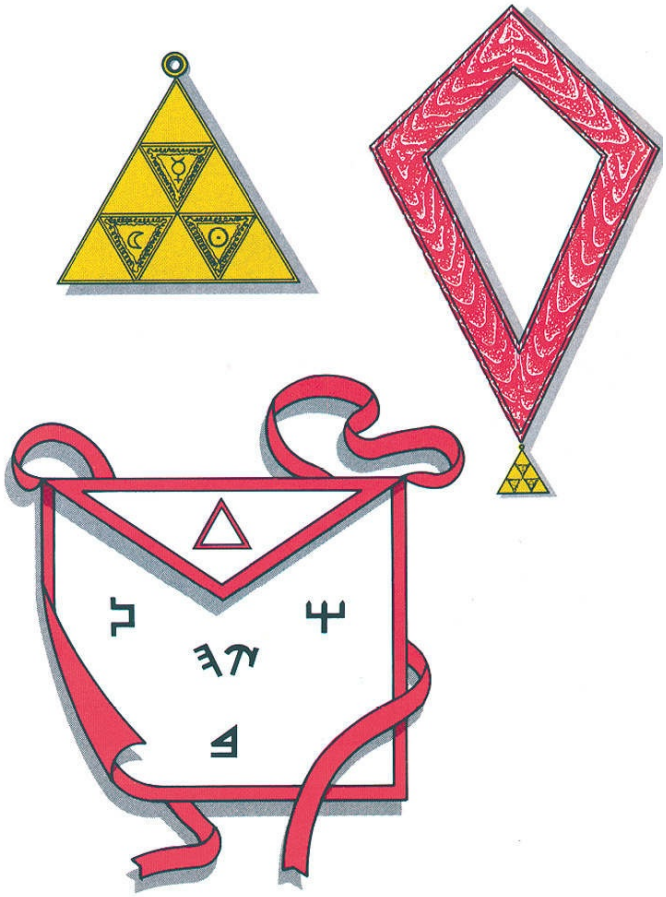
The 6th Degree – Intimate Secretary



The apron is of white lambskin bordered in bright crimson; on the flap is an embroidered equilateral triangle. The designs on the apron are Phoenician letters; in the center are the two letters 𐤀𐤌 which are on the apron of the 5th Degree. Three additional letters, 𐤁 (B), 𐤍 (N) and 𐤔 (Sh), appear at the upper corners and one in the center near the bottom. These are the initials of the words *berit, neder* and *shelemot*, meaning “a covenant, agreement or Divine Law”; “a promise or vow”; and, “completion, performance, an offering in accomplishment of a vow, perfect, salvation.” The Phoenician characters serve to remind us that the Master Hiram, though of a Jewish mother, was himself considered a Phoenician. He served a Phoenician king and presumably worshiped the Phoenician expression of the Deity.

The jewel is a triple–delta superimposed upon an equilateral triangle of gold. Each delta has a center design composed of one of the astrological or alchemical

signs ☉ ☾ ☿, signifying the Sun or gold, the Moon or silver, and Mercury or quicksilver. All three represent sources of Light, or Truth. To the ancients, the Sun was a “masculine” (active) symbol, as well as the source of the light which the “feminine” (passive) Moon reflects, while Mercury “harmonizes” or reconciles them (i.e., thesis, antithesis and synthesis). Thus understood, Mercury (also called Hermes), messenger of the gods, is a symbol of dynamic equilibrium, an apt symbol for the Master of the Lodge,[1] who illuminates his Brethren with good and wholesome instruction. As explained in the degree summary, the form of the jewel is utterly derived from Pike’s favorite source of Masonic symbolism, the Pythagorean Tetractys.

The cordon is a broad watered crimson ribbon, worn from right to left, or a collar of similar material, with the jewel suspended from it.

DUTIES

Be zealous, faithful, disinterested and benevolent. Act the peacemaker.

LESSONS

Zeal and fidelity to duty are always rewarded.

FOR REFLECTION

Why act the peacemaker?

IMPORTANT SYMBOLS

Triple–delta, King Solomon, King Hiram, the color crimson.

We read in the Holy Writings:

Now Hiram the king of Tyre had furnished Solomon with cedar trees and fir–trees, and with gold, according to all his desire, that then King Solomon gave Hiram twenty cities in the land of Galilee.

And Hiram came out from Tyre to see the cities which Solomon had given him; and they pleased him not (1 Kings 9:11–12).

Although the Biblical account ends as above, the story is allegorically extended here to provide certain lessons. The focus of the story is an argument

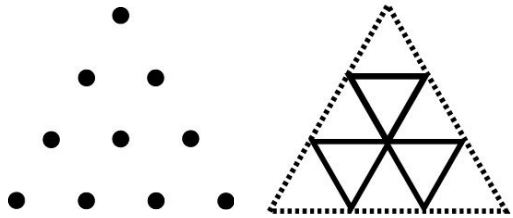
over this agreement between King Solomon and King Hiram of Tyre.

CEREMONY

The lodge represents the Audience Chamber of King Solomon. Again, we see hangings and an altar cover of black with silver tears. In this degree they are to remind us of the great sorrow suffered by our ancient brothers at the death of Hiram and to recall to our minds Hiram's virtues. Further, they are meant to incite us to act such that our memory may be honored among Masons.

The three candelabra with nine candles each are arranged to form three sets of three equilateral triangles. Similarly, the jewel is a triple–delta mounted upon a triangular plate.

The triple–delta is more of a mystery today than it was in Pike's time. In the Scottish Rite workings of the Symbolic Degrees (1–3) the Pythagorean Tetractys is an important symbol. Since it is not to be found in the York Rite symbols of these degrees, it is not well known among Masons in America, virtually all of whom take the first three degrees in York Rite lodges. It is a simple diagram of ten dots arranged as shown.



Within its boundaries are many important symbols which are revealed in stages throughout the ceremonies and lectures of many degrees. The Triple Triangle is the first example in the American Scottish Rite system and is seen, by connecting the proper dots, in the illustration to the right. By also connecting the outer dots, the jewel of this degree is completed. The candidate represents Zabud, a faithful servant of King Solomon. The other principal characters are King Solomon and King Hiram.

The drama starts in the preparation room when the candidate sees King Hiram rush hastily into King Solomon's Audience Chamber. The candidate is then placed outside of the Chamber near a slightly open door and instructed to listen

carefully. He witnesses King Hiram angrily accusing King Solomon of dishonesty. King Solomon gave twenty cities in Galilee to King Hiram in exchange for lumber from Lebanon and for sending the Master Hiram to direct the work. Upon King Hiram's inspection of these cities, he found only villages in ruins. King Hiram observes that he is not honest who does not keep his word in the spirit as well as in the letter.

As Solomon begins to explain his intentions, King Hiram notices Zabud and accuses Solomon of putting spies at the door. He rushes to the door, seizes Zabud and draws a sword. Solomon wisely counsels King Hiram to pause and reflect because Zabud should be tried and heard in his own defense. Zabud is then turned over to the guards and the two kings resume their discussion. Solomon explains that it was his intent to rebuild the cities, but the unexpected death of the Master, brought King Hiram before the rebuilding was begun. King Hiram's hasty words and unkind thoughts are forgiven and forgotten. Solomon asks, "Is there no one we can forgive, as God forgives our faults and errors?"

Zabud is then brought before the Kings and accused of being an eavesdropper, dishonorable, and curious of matters not his concern. In his defense it is explained that Zabud, not knowing King Hiram and seeing him enter Solomon's Audience Chamber in anger, positioned himself so that he could come quickly to the defense of his King. Zabud is honored and rewarded for his fidelity and zeal. He is appointed the Intimate Secretary of both Kings Solomon and Hiram, a position held by the Master Hiram.

King Hiram returns the cities to Solomon and gives him a substantial contribution of gold toward the expenses of building the Temple. This is apparently Pike's interpretation of 2 Chronicles 8:2: "That the cities which [King Hiram] had restored to Solomon, Solomon built them, and caused the children of Israel to dwell there." The two Kings cement their brotherhood and agree to execute a new treaty between their countries.

As the candidate is invested with the jewel, cordon and apron of this degree, he is instructed that the symbolic color of the degree – crimson, which represents

zeal– should remind him to be ready to shed his blood when duty, honor or manhood require it.

The final instruction summarizes the special lessons taught hereto be zealous, faithful, disinterested and benevolent and to act the peacemaker.

Zeal and fidelity are represented by the character of Zabud. Benevolence and disinterestedness are conveyed by the attitude of King Solomon; the lack thereof is seen in the hasty actions and judgments of King Hiram. Both King Solomon and King Hiram (after all is explained) act the peacemakers.

LECTURE

Pike does not address the virtues presented in this degree directly in the lecture. Rather he discusses the importance of duty, inferring that the Mason should ever be faithful to duty and perform his duty with zeal. Benevolence, disinterestedness and acting the peacemaker are explained in terms of generosity.

Fidelity and Zeal (in the Performance of Duty):

Duty is the moral magnetism which controls and guides the true Mason's course over the tumultuous seas of life (p. 119).

To perform that duty, whether the performance be rewarded or unrewarded, is [the Mason's] sole care. And it doth not matter, though of this performance there may be no witnesses, and though what he does will be forever unknown to all mankind (p. 119).

We are not born for ourselves alone; and our country claims her share, and our friends their share of us. As all that the earth produces is created for the use of man, so men are created for the sake of men, that they may mutually do good to one another. ...sometimes by receiving, sometimes by giving, and sometimes to cement human society by arts, by industry, and by our resources (p. 120).

Benevolence:

Suffer others to be praised in thy presence, and entertain their good and glory with delight; but at no hand disparage them, or lessen the report, or make an

objection; and think not the advancement of thy brother is a lessening of thy worth (p. 120).

We should either be more severe to ourselves, or less so to others, and consider that whatsoever good any one can think or say of us, we can tell him of many unworthy and foolish and perhaps worse actions of ours, any one of which, done by another, would be enough, with us, to destroy his reputation (p. 120).

Masons must be kind and affectionate one to another. ...There needs to be much more of the spirit of the ancient fellowship among us; more tenderness for each other's faults, more forgiveness, more solicitude for each other's improvement and good fortune; somewhat of brotherly feeling, that it be not shame to use the word "brother" (p. 122).

Disinterestedness:

It should be objection sufficient to exclude any man from the society of Masons, that he is not disinterested and generous, both in his acts, and in his opinions of men, and his constructions of their conduct (p. 121).

Generosity and a liberal spirit make men to be humane and genial, open–hearted, frank, and sincere, earnest to do good, easy and contented, and well–wishers of mankind. ...Nor can any man any more be a Mason than he can be a gentleman, unless he is generous, liberal, and disinterested. To be liberal, but only of that which is our own; to be generous, but only when we have first been just; to give, when to give deprives us of a luxury or a comfort, this is Masonry indeed (p. 122).

Act the Peacemaker:

The duty of the Mason is to endeavor to make man think better of his neighbor; to quiet, instead of aggravating difficulties; to bring together those who are severed or estranged; to keep friends from becoming foes, and to persuade foes to become friends. To do this, he must needs control his own passions, and be not rash and hasty, nor swift to take offence, nor easy to be angered (p. 123).

See, therefore, that first controlling your own temper, and governing your own passions, you fit yourself to keep peace and harmony among other men, and especially the brethren. Above all remember that Masonry is the realm of peace, and that "among Masons there must be no dissension, but only that noble emulation, which can best work and best agree" (p. 124).

Who can sum up the horrors and woes accumulated in a single war? Masonry is not dazzled with all its pomp and circumstance, all its glitter and glory. War comes with its bloody hand into our very dwellings. It takes from ten thousand homes those who lived there in peace and comfort, held by the tender ties of family and kindred. It drags them away, to die untended, of fever or exposure, in infectious climes; or to be hacked, torn, and mangled in the fierce fight; to fall on the gory field, to rise no more, to be borne away, in awful agony, to noisome and horrid hospitals. The groans of the battle field are echoed in sighs of bereavement from thousands of desolated hearths. There is a skeleton in every house, a vacant chair at every table. ...Treasures are expended, that would suffice to build ten thousand churches, hospitals, and universities, or rib and tie together a continent with rails of iron. If that treasure were sunk in the sea, it would be calamity enough; but it is put to worse use; for it is expended in cutting into the veins and arteries of human life, until the earth is deluged with a sea of blood (p. 124).

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1. This notion is further explained in Arturo de Hoyos, ed., *Albert Pike's Esoterika* (Washington, D.C.: Scottish Rite Research Society, 2005, 2009), pp. 103–6.